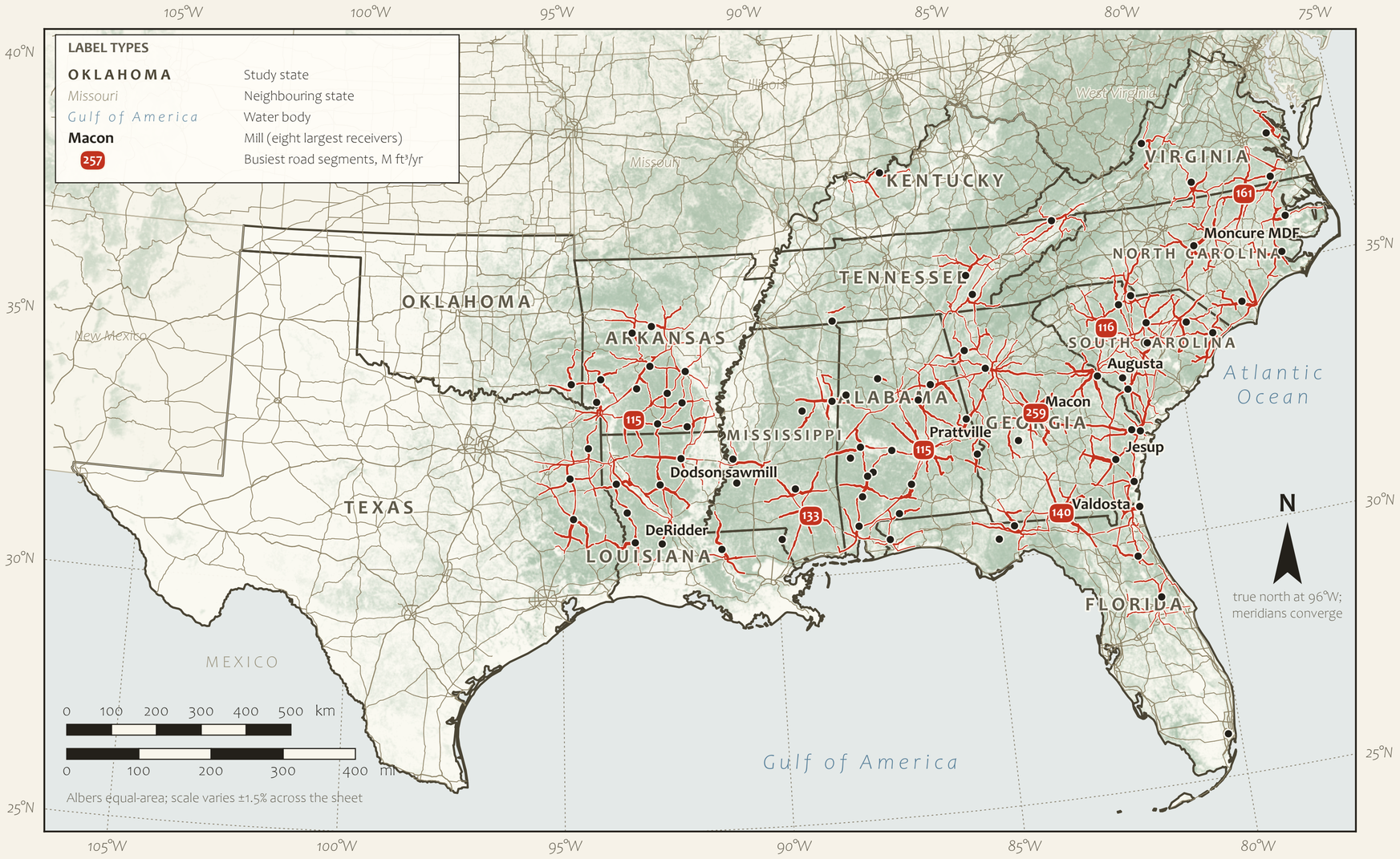
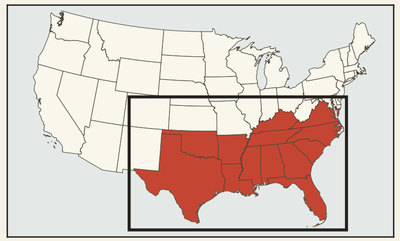
Forest to mill: where wood moves in the southern United States

DAY 2 / 30 DAYS 30 MAPS

Modelled hauling of FIA annual forest removals to wood mills by road | 13 states, Oklahoma and Texas to Virginia | a model, not a traffic count





STUDY AREA

Thirteen states from Oklahoma and Texas to Virginia, shown in colour. The box is the map extent.

13.2 bn ft³/yr of FIA removals

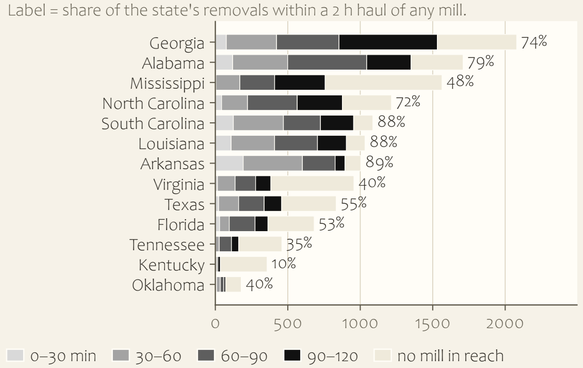
66% within a 2 h haul of a mill

70 min median haul to nearest mill

87 mills receiving wood

How far is each state's wood from a mill?

FIA removals by minutes to the nearest sample mill, million ft³ a year. Label = share of the state's removals within a 2 h haul of any mill.



HOW TO READ IT

Each forest hex (842 km²) sends its FIA removals to every mill within a 2 h road haul, weighted by travel time: a mill 15 minutes farther than the nearest receives about 37% of its share. Road thickness is the wood summed over every route crossing a segment; each haul counts once.

FOREST AND CANOPY

The underlay is USFS NLCD tree canopy cover for 2021 (percent of each 30 m pixel under tree crowns, averaged to 2 km). It is satellite-modelled and is not the FIA definition of forest. FIA gives county totals only, so each county's removals are placed in proportion to canopy; county totals are unchanged.

LEGEND

Road traffic, million ft³/yr

1 10 50 150 250

Tree canopy cover

0% 50% 100%

NLCD 2021, 2 km mean

- Sample mill, no closure recorded
- Other roads (Natural Earth 1:10m)
- 5° graticule (beneath the land)

BEFORE CITING

Mills are a 117-mill sample, so empty areas (Texas, Oklahoma, Kentucky) show missing mills as much as distance. Major roads only; speeds and circuity are assumed; mill capacity is ignored.

Data: USDA Forest Service FIA county estimates (annual removals, forest area; 2016-2025 evaluations); USFS NLCD Tree Canopy Cover v2025-6 (2021); Natural Earth 1:10m roads; US Census state and county boundaries via us-atlas; author-compiled mill list (Forisk / PPRC 2025, company announcements, trade press). Projection: spherical Albers equal-area conic (standard parallels 29.5°N and 45.5°N, origin 37.5°N 96°W, R = 6,371,008.8 m).